QAMAR SHAHZAD

Senior Python / Django Backend Engineer | AI-Assisted Development & Automation | DevOps

Python · Django · DRF · PostgreSQL · Redis · Celery · n8n · LLM / Voice AI Integration · Proxmox · CI/CD

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Backend-focused software engineer with 10+ years of experience designing, building, and operating production systems in Python and Django. Specialized in REST API development, relational data modeling, and scalable backend architecture using Django, Django REST Framework, PostgreSQL, Redis, and Celery for asynchronous task processing. Independently built and delivered multiple full-stack platforms (Tourism, Sports B2B, Accounting, B2B Commerce) with Django backends and Next.js frontends.

Increasingly focused on AI automation and LLM integration — building self-hosted, production-grade AI systems including a multilingual voice assistant for a travel platform (ElevenLabs TTS + LLM APIs), n8n-based workflow automation, and Claude / ChatGPT integrations that connect internal systems, booking engines, and customer-facing channels to reduce manual operational work. Strong DevOps foundation across managed cloud (AWS EC2/S3, Google Cloud) and self-hosted Proxmox infrastructure with Dockerized services and CI/CD pipelines. Focused on clean, maintainable code with attention to availability, scalability, security, and performance.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Backend & API Development: Python, Django, Django REST Framework, REST API Design, PostgreSQL, Relational Data Modeling, Redis, Celery (Async Task Queues), Flask, Booking Engines, Payment Gateway Integrations, Custom CRM / Admin Systems

AI Automation & Integration: Self-Hosted Voice AI (ElevenLabs TTS + LLM APIs, Multilingual), LLM Workflow Orchestration, n8n Pipelines, Claude / ChatGPT Integrations, MCP / Tool-Calling Integrations, RAG-ready Architectures, API-based AI Business Process Automation

Full-Stack Development: Next.js, JavaScript, ntfy (Push Notifications), End-to-End Platform Delivery (Tourism, Sports B2B, Accounting, B2B Commerce)

Cloud & Infrastructure: AWS (EC2, S3), Google Cloud VM, Proxmox Virtualization, Linux Server Administration, Docker, Application Deployment, Reverse Proxy / Web Server Configuration, SSL / DNS / Hosting Management

CI/CD & Code Quality: Jenkins Pipelines, SonarQube Code Quality Analysis, Nexus Repository Manager (Docker Image Caching), Git / GitHub, Automated Build & Deploy Workflows

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Backend Engineer — AI Automation & DevOps (Five Vertex Tourism / Independent)

Dubai, UAE | Mar 2025 – Present

- **Built a self-hosted, multilingual AI voice assistant for a travel booking platform** — integrating ElevenLabs TTS and LLM APIs to deliver real-time, natural, multi-language conversational booking and customer support, deployed on self-hosted infrastructure for full data control and cost efficiency.
- **Designed AI automation pipelines with n8n and LLM orchestration (Claude, ChatGPT)** — connecting booking systems, CRM, and messaging channels to automate quote generation, lead handling, and repetitive operational workflows.
- **Developed LLM tool / function-calling integrations** — enabling AI systems to securely query internal APIs and business data, moving beyond simple chat into actionable, backend-connected automation.
- Independently designed and delivered full-stack platforms (Tourism, Sports B2B, Accounting, B2B Commerce) with Django and Django REST Framework backends, PostgreSQL data models, Redis caching, Celery for asynchronous tasks, and Next.js frontends.
- Built and maintained REST APIs, backend business logic, admin workflows, and database schemas powering booking, reporting, and B2B commerce operations.
- Operating a Proxmox-based virtualization environment for deployment and systems work — including Jenkins CI/CD pipelines, SonarQube code quality analysis, and Nexus Docker image caching.
- Managing deployment environments, service configurations, and infrastructure optimization for reliability and performance across self-hosted and cloud setups.

Backend Developer / Technical Operations Engineer

Arabian Nights Tours, Dubai | 2012 – Mar 2025

- **Integrated AI chatbot and LLM-based automation into booking and customer-support workflows** — improving response efficiency, reducing manual handling, and laying the foundation for later AI-driven operational tooling.

- Built and maintained business-critical backend services using Python, Django, and REST APIs to support booking engines, reporting, operations, and customer-facing processes.
- Designed and maintained relational data models and database schemas in PostgreSQL, with Redis and Celery for caching and asynchronous task processing.
- Developed travel systems, booking engines, internal dashboards, and operational management platforms used daily by operations and management teams.
- Deployed and operated production applications on AWS (EC2 for compute, S3 for object storage) and Google Cloud VM, ensuring stability, uptime, and scalability, before transitioning core workloads to self-hosted Proxmox infrastructure.
- Integrated payment gateways and third-party APIs to improve business logic, response efficiency, and process automation.
- Worked closely with operational and management teams to translate business needs into practical, scalable backend solutions.
- Worked ~5 years on WordPress and Shopify — website and storefront management, content creation and publishing, product/package uploads, theme and plugin configuration, and on-page SEO — before transitioning into custom Python/Django backend development.

Web & Online Operations Executive
Al Nasir Travel, Pakistan | 2008 – 2012

- Supported online business operations through website management, digital systems setup, and service promotion.
- Assisted in improving online visibility and the technical structure of business websites and digital assets.
- Managed web-related updates, content publishing, and online customer acquisition support.

KEY PROJECTS

- **Multilingual Self-Hosted AI Voice Assistant (Travel Platform)** — Real-time conversational voice bot for booking and customer support, integrating ElevenLabs TTS with LLM APIs, deployed on self-hosted infrastructure. Supports multiple languages and connects to backend booking logic. Stack: Python, LLM APIs, ElevenLabs, Django/DRF, Proxmox.
- **Travel Operations & Booking Platform** — Django/DRF backend powering a custom booking engine with admin workflows, reporting, and operational tooling; PostgreSQL data model with Redis caching and Celery task queues. Stack: Django, DRF, PostgreSQL, Redis, Celery, Next.js.
- **Sports B2B Commerce Platform (Five Motion Sports)** — End-to-end B2B platform (fmsportz.com) with a Django REST API covering product catalogue, MOQ / lead-time management, and OEM workflows. Stack: Django, DRF, PostgreSQL, Redis, Celery, ntfy, Next.js.
- **AI-Powered Automation Workflows** — Backend automation services using n8n, LLM/chat integrations, and API-based orchestration for internal and client-facing operations.
- **Accounting & Financial Management Platform** — Full-stack accounting system with transaction management, reporting dashboards, and business process automation. Stack: Django, PostgreSQL, Next.js.
- **CI/CD & DevOps Lab (Proxmox)** — Self-hosted DevOps environment with Jenkins CI/CD pipelines, SonarQube code quality analysis, Nexus Docker image registry, and Proxmox virtualization.

EDUCATION

- Executive MBA – Hospitality & Tourism | National Institute of Business Management | 2017 – 2018
- Bachelor of Business Administration (BBA) | Virtual University | 2009 – 2012

TOOLS & TECHNOLOGIES

Backend & Languages: Python, Django, Django REST Framework, Flask, REST APIs, JavaScript

AI / Automation: n8n, LLM APIs, ElevenLabs (Voice AI), Claude, ChatGPT, MCP / Tool-Calling, API Integrations

Databases & Async: PostgreSQL, Redis, Celery, ntfy (Push Notifications)

Cloud & Infrastructure: AWS (EC2, S3), Google Cloud, Proxmox, Linux, Docker, Git, GitHub

CI/CD & Code Quality: Jenkins, SonarQube, Nexus Repository Manager

Frontend & Platforms: Next.js, HTML, CSS, WordPress, Custom CRM, Booking Engines, Payment Integrations